

89 Joash and Jehoiada

A rescued boy king and the faithful priest who raised him, and what happened when the priest was gone.

Joash was the only royal heir to escape Athaliah's massacre. His aunt Jehosheba hid him in the temple for six years. Her husband, Jehoiada the high priest, then risked everything to crown the seven-year-old and restore David's line. While Jehoiada lived, Joash did well and repaired the temple. But after the old priest died, Joash turned to idols and even had Jehoiada's son stoned in the temple court. Their story asks whether a borrowed faith will hold when the mentor is gone.

At a glance

<i>Names</i>	Joash (Jehoash), "the LORD has given"; Jehoiada, "the LORD knows"
<i>Joash's family</i>	Son of Ahaziah and Zibiah; father of Amaziah (2 Kings 12:1, 21)
<i>Jehoiada's family</i>	Husband of Jehosheba; father of Zechariah (2 Chronicles 24:20)
<i>Reign</i>	Crowned at 7; reigned 40 years, c. 835–796 BC
<i>Key places</i>	The temple in Jerusalem; the house of Baal
<i>Key people</i>	Athaliah, Jehosheba, Zechariah, Hazael king of Syria
<i>Main passages</i>	2 Kings 11–12; 2 Chronicles 22:10–24:27
<i>New Testament</i>	Possibly Matthew 23:35; Luke 11:51 (see page 4)

"And Jehoash did that which was right in the sight of the LORD all his days wherein Jehoiada the priest instructed him."

2 Kings 12:2, KJV

The life of Joash and Jehoiada

Dates are approximate (BC). Scripture dates Joash's temple repairs to his 23rd year but does not date Jehoiada's death.

c. 841 BC

Infant

● Rescued and hidden

Athaliah destroys the royal family. Jehosheba steals away baby Joash with his nurse and hides him in the temple for six years. *2 Kings 11:1-3; 2 Chronicles 22:10-12*

c. 835 BC

Age 7

● Crowned in the temple

Jehoiada shows the captains the king's son and crowns him. The people shout, "God save the king." *2 Kings 11:4-12, 21; 2 Chronicles 23:1-11*

c. 835 BC

First year

● Covenant renewed

Jehoiada makes a covenant between the LORD, king and people. Athaliah is killed and Baal's house torn down. *2 Kings 11:13-20; 2 Chronicles 23:12-21*

c. 813 BC

23rd year

● The temple repaired

Jehoiada sets a chest with a hole in its lid by the altar, and the gifts pay the workers. *2 Kings 12:4-16; 2 Chronicles 24:4-14*

Later in the
reign

Age 130

● Jehoiada dies

The old priest dies full of days. He is buried among the kings, because he had done good in Israel. *2 Chronicles 24:15-16*

After
Jehoiada's
death

● Joash turns away

Judah's princes bow to the king, and he listens to them. They leave the temple and serve idols. Joash has Zechariah, Jehoiada's son, stoned for rebuking them. *2 Chronicles 24:17-22*

c. 796 BC

Age 47

● Joash is killed

Hazael of Syria threatens Jerusalem, and Joash buys him off with the temple's treasures. Later his own servants kill him in his bed. *2 Kings 12:17-21; 2 Chronicles 24:23-27*

Key activities

Kings and Chronicles tell Joash's story differently. Kings focuses on the temple repairs and says little about his decline. Chronicles adds the idolatry after Jehoiada's death and the stoning of Zechariah.

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- 1 **Jehoiada protected the heir.** He and his wife kept the boy hidden in the temple for six years. *2 Kings 11:3; 2 Chronicles 22:11-12*

 - 2 **Jehoiada crowned the king.** He armed the guards with David's own spears and shields and set the crown and the testimony on Joash. *2 Kings 11:9-12*

 - 3 **Jehoiada renewed the covenant.** He bound king and people to be the LORD's people and led them in breaking down Baal's house. *2 Kings 11:17-18*

 - 4 **Joash did right while taught.** He did right "all his days wherein Jehoiada the priest instructed him." The high places remained. *2 Kings 12:2-3*

 - 5 **Joash pressed for repairs.** He challenged Jehoiada and the priests over the slow work. *2 Kings 12:6-8; 2 Chronicles 24:5-6*

 - 6 **They set up the chest.** The people gave gladly, and honest workmen restored the house of the LORD. *2 Kings 12:9-15; 2 Chronicles 24:8-14*

 - 7 **Joash turned to idols.** After Jehoiada died, the king listened to the princes, and Judah served groves and idols. *2 Chronicles 24:17-18*

 - 8 **Joash killed Jehoiada's son.** Zechariah warned, "because ye have forsaken the LORD, he hath also forsaken you." He was stoned in the temple court at the king's command. *2 Chronicles 24:20-22*

 - 9 **Joash paid off Hazael.** He sent the temple's hallowed things and gold to the king of Syria. *2 Kings 12:17-18*

Across Scripture

Direct references come first. Thematic echoes are study connections, not places where the text names Joash or Jehoiada.

Old Testament

2 Kings 11:1–12:21	Kings: the crowning and the temple repairs
2 Chronicles 22:10–24:27	Chronicles adds Joash's turning after Jehoiada died
2 Chronicles 24:22	Joash "remembered not the kindness" and slew his son
Jeremiah 29:26	A priest "in the stead of Jehoiada"; possibly another man
Echo: 1 Samuel 2:18–21	Samuel also grew up in God's house
Echo: 2 Kings 22:1–2	Josiah, another boy king who began well

New Testament

Matthew 23:35; Luke 11:51	"Zacharias" slain; many say Jehoiada's son, some the prophet
Matthew 1:8	Joash is skipped in Matthew's genealogy
Echo: Hebrews 13:7	Remember faithful leaders, "whose faith follow"

For discussion

1. *Observe:* What words describe how long Joash did right (2 Kings 12:2)?
2. *Understand:* Why do you think Joash's faith did not survive Jehoiada's death?
3. *Apply:* Who has been a Jehoiada for you? How could you thank them or pass on what they gave you?
4. *Apply:* What would help your faith stand on its own, not only when strong believers are around you?